



Kayaking the Little Beaver Creek

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[Little Beaver Creek](#) was designated a Wild and Scenic River by the Department of Natural Resources in 1974. This creek offers breathtaking scenery, a peek into our nation's history and memories to last a lifetime.

The designation of "wild and scenic" is a perfect description for this river. Relatively untouched by development, the paddler will enjoy rolling hills of green, a few rock outcroppings and Class II rapids with American Sycamore trees arced over the water throughout this journey.

The two most popular sections for this river are from [Little Beaver Creek State Park to Fredericktown](#), and from [Fredericktown](#) to the newly developed Lock 57 Community [Park](#) at the mouth of the creek as it empties into the Ohio River. (Ohio anglers beware, the river crosses into PA territory as it nears the Ohio River.) Both sections are often run together. However, this does not allow much time for exploration.

Along the banks, you will notice large stone structures called locks which were built in the mid 1800's. This system of water management, known as the Sandy and Beaver Canal, linked the Ohio River to the Ohio-Erie canal system. All of the locks found along the creek are remnants which are slowly deteriorating and are not safe to walk upon, however, a complete restoration can be found at the Little Beaver Creek State Park. In fact, there is so much to see and do in this area, that it would be wise to throw a tent in the car "just in case."

As always, know the river you are about to paddle, check the [water levels](#), wear your [PFD](#) and have fun!

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